CITY OF OAKWOOD
STATE OF OHIO
JULY 20, 2026

The Council of the City of Oakwood, State of Ohio, met in a work session at 6:30 p.m. in the conference room of the City of Oakwood, 30 Park Avenue, Oakwood, Ohio 45419. Council then met in a regular session at 7:30 p.m. in the council chambers of the City of Oakwood.

The meeting was streamed live on the Oakwood city website and broadcast on Cable Access Channel 6.

The Mayor, Mr. William Duncan, presided, and the Clerk, Ms. Lori Stacel, recorded. Mayor Duncan asked all present to participate in the Pledge of Allegiance.

Upon call of the roll, the following members of Council responded to their names:

MR. WILLIAM D. DUNCAN.....PRESENT
MR. STEVEN BYINGTON.....PRESENT
MRS. LEIGH TURBEN.....PRESENT
MRS. HEALY JACKSON.....PRESENT
MR. SAM DORF.....PRESENT

Officers of the City present were the following:

Mrs. Katie Smiddy, City Manager
Mr. Robert F. Jacques, City Attorney
Mr. Chris Kuzma, City Engineer/Assistant Public Works Director
Ms. Lori Stacel, Clerk of Council

The following visitors registered:

Cheryl Suich, 291 W. Thruston Boulevard
Karen Knoll, 295 W. Thruston Boulevard
David Suich, 291 W. Thruston Boulevard
Brian Barr, *Oakwood Register*

Mr. Dorf advised Council he had read the meeting minutes of the June 1, 2026, regular session and work session, and the June 15, 2026, work session. Mr. Dorf reported that he found the minutes to be correct and complete. Therefore, it was moved by Mr. Dorf and seconded by Mrs. Turben that the minutes of the sessions of Council aforementioned be approved as written and the reading thereof at this session be dispensed with. Upon a viva voce vote on the question of the motion, same passed unanimously, and it was so ordered.

STATUS REPORTS – NONE

VISITORS

Karen Knoll, 295 W. Thruston Boulevard, addressed Council regarding the maintenance of tall grass on property owned by the Dayton Country Club along the Kettering side of W. Thruston Boulevard. She explained that Dayton Country Club has implemented a landscape plan utilizing native grasses to reduce maintenance and costs, resulting in grass reaching approximately eight inches in height adjacent to neighboring properties. Ms. Knoll stated that she has communicated with both the City of Kettering and Dayton Country Club and noted that Kettering recently adopted landscape standards for golf courses that allow taller native grass. She expressed concern that the area has become increasingly unattractive and requested that the City of Oakwood work with the City of Kettering and Dayton Country Club to encourage improved maintenance.

Cheryl Suich, 291 W. Thruston Boulevard, also commented on the lack of maintenance at the Dayton Country Club along W. Thruston Boulevard. She shared photographs of the tall grasses across from the Oakwood residences on W. Thruston Boulevard. She stated that she had previously discussed the issue with representatives of the Dayton Country Club and Vice Mayor Byington, resulting in some maintenance improvements, but indicated that the condition remains a long-term concern. She stated that residents chose to live in Oakwood because of its high community standards and asked the City to continue working with Kettering and Dayton Country Club to address the issue.

David Suich, 291 W. Thruston Boulevard, thanked City staff, including the Public Safety Department and Law Director, for their efforts in assisting with the tall grass issue at the Dayton Country Club. He discussed concerns related to property rights, easements, and rights-of-way, referencing recent utility work and a survey of the property. Mr. Suich requested that the City continue working with neighboring jurisdictions and the Dayton Country Club to help resolve ongoing concerns.

Mayor Duncan responded that the property in question is located within the City of Kettering and therefore outside Oakwood's jurisdiction. Law Director Rob Jacques stated that the City has communicated with Kettering officials regarding the matter and explained that the Dayton Country Club is complying with Kettering's landscape requirements, including maintaining the required setback from the right-of-way. Mrs. Suich stated that although the property may be in compliance with Kettering's standards, residents believe it does not reflect Oakwood's expectations for maintenance.

LEGISLATION

A RESOLUTION
BY VICE MAYOR BYINGTON NO 1952
A RESOLUTION PROVIDING FOR AN ELECTION ON THE QUESTION OF A RENEWAL TAX LEVY IN EXCESS OF THE TEN-MILL LIMITATION FOR CURRENT EXPENSES AND THE GENERAL OPERATION OF THE CITY.

A copy of the resolution, having been placed on the desks of each member of Council prior to introduction, was read by title.

Vice Mayor Byington explained the City has an existing 2.72 mill property tax levy that is due to expire at the end of 2026. The 2.72 mill levy was first approved by Oakwood voters in 1991 and has been renewed every five years since then. This is a resolution to place the renewal levy on the ballot in November. It is an updated version of the same resolution that Council adopted in June, with a formatting amendment requested by the Secretary of State's office. It is important to note that since this is a renewal instead of a new levy, it will maintain the current level of property taxation and will not increase property taxes.

Thereupon, it was moved by Vice Mayor Byington and seconded by Mr. Dorf that the resolution be passed.

Upon call of the roll on the question of the motion, the following vote was recorded:

MR. WILLIAM D. DUNCAN.....YEA
MR. STEVEN BYINGTON.....YEA
MRS. LEIGH TURBEN.....YEA
MRS. HEALY JACKSON.....YEA
MR. SAM DORF.....YEA

There being five (5) yea votes and no (0) nay votes thereon, said resolution was declared duly passed and it was so ordered.

AN ORDINANCE
BY MR. DORF NO 5039
AN ORDINANCE TO LEVY SPECIAL ASSESSMENTS FOR THE CONSTRUCTION OR RECONSTRUCTION OF SIDEWALKS AND APPURTENANCES THERETO IN THE CITY OF OAKWOOD, OHIO.

A copy of the ordinance, having been placed on the desks of each member of Council prior to introduction, was read by title.

Mr. Dorf explained that this ordinance is the third piece of legislation for last year's Sidewalk Repair Project authorizing the assessment of sidewalk repair costs that have not been paid directly by affected homeowners. There are 33 unpaid invoices totaling $13,139.34.

Thereupon, it was moved by Mr. Dorf and seconded by Vice Mayor Byington that the second reading be waived and that the ordinance be passed tonight.

Upon call of the roll on the question of the motion, the following vote was recorded:

MR. WILLIAM D. DUNCAN.....YEA
MR. STEVEN BYINGTON.....YEA
MRS. LEIGH TURBEN.....YEA
MRS. HEALY JACKSON.....YEA
MR. SAM DORF.....YEA

There being five (5) yea votes and no (0) nay votes thereon, said ordinance was declared duly passed and it was so ordered.

STAFF REPORT

Mr. Chris Kuzma, City Engineer and Assistant Public Works Director, presented the Engineering and Public Works Department staff report. The report included personnel updates, noting recent hires, a pending Parks Foreman start date, and several vacancies in progress.

Mr. Kuzma reviewed the Department's current initiatives, including the 2026 Asphalt Repaving Program, Sidewalk, Curb, and Driveway Apron Project, Concrete Street Repair Project, and Public Works facility renovations. The asphalt project was awarded to John R. Jurgensen Company in the amount of $454,530, and the sidewalk project was awarded to A to Z Property Maintenance in the amount of $539,185. The Concrete Street Repair Project is expected to bid in summer 2026 with a $400,000 budget.

Updates were also provided on planned infrastructure improvements, including water main projects, Public Works yard upgrades, and technology enhancements at Smith Gardens. Mr. Kuzma highlighted ongoing efforts related to the Lead and Copper Rule Improvements program and the Fishbeck Water System Studies, which outline a long-term capital improvement plan totaling approximately $60.4 million over twenty years.

Additional updates included service contracts for tree services and landscaping, along with recent maintenance activities. Mr. Kuzma also reported on progress related to the Park Master Plan, supported by grant funding, and concluded by reaffirming the Department's commitment to maintaining and improving the City's infrastructure.

Mayor Duncan inquired about approved service line materials. Mr. Kuzma noted that most service lines are copper, with some plastic components.

Mrs. Turben referenced Fishbeck's presentation regarding a low-cost method of identifying lead service lines and asked whether a similar option is available to residents. Mr. Kuzma explained that a tool can be used at the shutoff valve to assist with identification for residents.

Mrs. Jackson asked about the City's approach to identifying service lines. Mr. Kuzma stated that the work is being completed on a district-by-district basis and that the next phase will focus on determining the most effective strategy for addressing service lines with unknown materials.

Mr. Dorf inquired about new staffing, specifically the management analyst position. Mr. Kuzma explained that the role will focus on data entry, customer service, and improving operational efficiency as the department works toward modernization. He noted that a job description is currently in development.

Mrs. Smiddy referenced the study recommendation to implement a Computerized Maintenance Management System (CMMS) to allow residents to report issues online. She confirmed that the City is evaluating various systems and that the management analyst will play a key role in system implementation, data management, and reporting.

Mrs. Jackson asked about water meter replacement. Mr. Kuzma indicated that the project is anticipated to be included in next year's budget and will likely be implemented as a multi-year initiative.

Mrs. Smiddy noted the need for new meters in coordination with Lead and Copper Rule requirements. She emphasized the importance of developing a strategic approach to divide the community into manageable areas to complete replacements on an annual, coordinated basis.

Mrs. Jackson also inquired about Public Works yard improvements. Mr. Kuzma stated that the project is currently in the design phase, with preliminary work being completed internally.

CITY MANAGER'S COMMENTS:

The final Blanket Concert of the season will be held at Smith Gardens on Sunday, August 2, at 7:00 p.m., followed by the Annual Ice Cream Social on Sunday, August 9, from 3:30 to 7:00 p.m. Both events provide opportunities for residents to connect with one another, as well as with City Council and City staff. The 2026 Asphalt Repaving Program is underway, and residents are reminded to observe posted "No Parking" signs and keep streets clear to help crews complete the work safely and efficiently. In addition, the City's annual Sidewalk, Curb, and Driveway Apron Program is scheduled to begin the week of July 27 as part of ongoing infrastructure maintenance efforts to address minor repairs before they develop into more significant issues.

COUNCIL COMMENTS

Mr. Dorf extended belated recognition of the 250th anniversary of the Declaration of Independence and commented on the community's patriotic displays, noting strong resident participation and community spirit. He also recognized Rowan, a young resident, for establishing the "Oakwood Compost Crew," a small-scale service collecting yard waste for composting.

Mrs. Jackson referenced the book *Sidewalk Nation: The Life and Law of America's Most Overlooked Public Resource* as sidewalk replacement work is scheduled to begin the following week. She highlighted the importance of sidewalks as essential public infrastructure and encouraged residents to help preserve this valuable community asset by maintaining sidewalks adjacent to their properties in good repair.

Mrs. Turben reported on unauthorized solicitation activity by individuals claiming to represent Altafiber. No permits had been issued, and the activity was in violation of local regulations. Residents were encouraged to contact the Public Safety Department if approached.

Mayor Duncan recognized Public Safety Officer Rothenberger and Lieutenant Staley for their response to a retail theft incident at CVS during That Day in May, noting that information shared with the Tactical Crime Suppression Unit, along with the use of Flock camera technology, led to the identification and arrest of suspects, the recovery of more than $12,000 in stolen merchandise, and the disruption of a larger organized retail crime operation; he also reported attending the Gala of Hope at the Masonic Temple, where approximately $2.1 million was raised for local cancer research, and commended the contributions of Oakwood residents and community members; additionally, Mayor Duncan reported on an incident in the Hatcher's Platt area in which Public Safety Officers apprehended a suspect following a series of related incidents, noting the suspect fled after stealing a vehicle, later crashed near the Dayton Country Club, and was ultimately taken into custody at a residence in the Southview area with assistance from the Kettering Police Department, including drone and K-9 support, and was transported to Miami Valley Hospital for treatment.

The public meeting concluded at 8:48 p.m.

William D Duncan

MAYOR

ATTEST:

Lori Ahrel

CLERK OF COUNCIL